

Report on the Activities and Functions of the Departments of Statistics under the Government of Kerala and Government of India

Statistics plays an important role in government administration, economic planning, policy formulation and public welfare. In Kerala, the **Department of Economics and Statistics (DES)** acts as the nodal agency for the state statistical system. At the national level, the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** is the central authority responsible for coordinating and developing the official statistical system of India.

The **Department of Economics and Statistics, Kerala** is responsible for the systematic collection, compilation, analysis, interpretation and dissemination of statistical information relating to different sectors of the state's economy. Its activities cover population and demographics, agriculture, industries, prices, state income, labour, housing, infrastructure, environment and other socio-economic areas. The department conducts surveys and statistical studies and provides data required for planning and decision-making. It operates through the Directorate, District Statistical Offices and Taluk Statistical Offices, supported by statistical cells in various departments of the state government.

Important activities of the Kerala department include **agricultural statistics, population and vital statistics, the Index of Industrial Production, Annual Survey of Industries, price statistics, state income estimation, National Sample Survey activities and economic and socio-economic surveys**. It also publishes statistical reports, handbooks, fact sheets and other datasets and provides dashboards and data analytics for important indicators. The department participates in national census and survey activities and provides statistical support to different government departments.

At the national level, **MoSPI** is the nodal ministry for the planned and organized development of India's statistical system. It coordinates statistical activities among central ministries, state governments and other stakeholders and works to maintain standards, concepts, classifications and methodologies for official statistics. Its Statistics Wing conducts and coordinates major nationwide surveys such as the **Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), Annual Survey of**

Industries (ASI), Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) and other socio-economic surveys.

MoSPI also prepares important national statistics, including **National Accounts Statistics**, which provide measures such as GDP and GVA. It develops the **National Indicator Framework for Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** and publishes statistical reports relating to areas such as energy, environment, women and men, labour and economic activity. In addition, its Programme Implementation Wing monitors major central sector projects and the implementation of the Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS).

Thus, the statistical departments at both state and national levels provide the evidence required for effective governance. Their activities transform large amounts of raw data into reliable statistical information, supporting economic planning, policy evaluation, resource allocation and informed decision-making. The coordination between Kerala's statistical system and India's national statistical system is therefore essential for evidence-based development.